

**BEFORE THE STATE BOARD OF ADDICTION COUNSELOR EXAMINERS AND
STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR EXAMINERS**

STATE OF COLORADO

Case Nos. 2018-7201 and 2018-7202

STIPULATION AND FINAL BOARD ORDER

**IN THE MATTER OF DISCIPLINARY PROCEEDINGS REGARDING THE
CERTIFICATION TO PRACTICE ADDICTION COUNSELING AND THE
LICENSE TO PRACTICE PROFESSIONAL COUNSELING IN THE STATE OF
COLORADO OF STEPHANIE JOY NORRIS, LICENSE NOS. LAC 822 AND LPC
13426,**

Respondent.

**IT IS HEREBY STIPULATED by and between the State Board of Addiction
Counselor Examiners and State Board of Licensed Professional Counselor
Examiners ("the Boards") and Stephanie Joy Norris ("Respondent") as follows:**

- 1. Respondent is a licensed professional counselor ("LPC") within the
State of Colorado, license number LPC 13246.**
- 2. Respondent obtained her license to practice as an LPC on November
16, 2016, and has been so licensed at all times relevant herein.**
- 3. Respondent is a licensed addiction counselor ("LAC") within the State
of Colorado, license number LAC 822.**
- 4. Respondent obtained her license to practice as a LAC on March 28,
2017, and has been so licensed at all times relevant herein.**
- 5. The Boards have jurisdiction over Respondent and the subject matter
herein pursuant to the provisions of the Mental Health Practice Act, § 12-43-101 *et
seq.*, C.R.S. ("MHPA").**
- 6. It is the intent of the parties and the purpose of this Order to provide
for a settlement of all matters arising out of case numbers 2018-7201 and 2018-
7202, without the necessity of holding a formal hearing.**

7. This Order is a full and final resolution of case numbers 2018-7201 and 2018-7202. This Order does not resolve any other cases, complaints, or matters, known or unknown to the Boards or Respondent, as of the effective date of this Order.

8. Respondent admits the following:

- a. In or around June 2018, Respondent began providing therapy to two (2) minor children.
- b. During the time Respondent provided therapy to the two (2) minor children, there was a pending custody case wherein the Court ordered Respondent to provide a status report on said therapy.
- c. In the status report/letter to the Court, Respondent made parenting time recommendations which was not her role as there was a Child and Family Investigator ("CFI") assigned to the case.
- d. Respondent's mandatory disclosure statement ("MDS") was inadequate.

9. By virtue of the facts admitted in paragraph 8 above, Respondent admits, and the Boards find, that Respondent violated §§ 12-43-214(1)(b)(I) and 12-43-222(1)(g)(I) and (p), C.R.S. Respondent is subject to the following disciplinary sanctions that the Boards believe are necessary to protect the public health, safety, and welfare.

ADMONITION

10. On the basis of the findings set forth in paragraphs 8 and 9 above, the Boards hereby admonish Respondent for violations of §§ 12-43-214(1)(b)(I) and 12-43-222(1)(g)(I) and (p), C.R.S. This Order is effective as a Letter of Admonition pursuant to § 12-43-223(3)(d), C.R.S. As part of the admonishment, Respondent agrees to the following terms as a Board Order:

CONTINUING EDUCATION

11. Within two (2) years of the effective date of this Order, Respondent must successfully complete 20 hours of Board-approved professional continuing education ("CE") courses in the areas of high conflict divorce and ethics. Respondent shall obtain the Boards' approval of the courses prior to enrolling in

each course. Upon completion of a course, Respondent shall ensure that a certificate of completion is provided to the Boards.

12. The CE hours completed pursuant to this section shall be required in addition to, and may not be counted toward, the mandatory Continuing Professional Development requirements for an active Colorado license or to meet any other licensure requirements.

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

13. Respondent shall strictly observe the prohibitions set forth in § 12-43-222(1), C.R.S., and will ensure that she does not engage in any activities that are prohibited and that she practices in accordance with generally accepted standards of practice.

14. All expenses incurred or associated with education or any other requirement necessary to fulfill the terms of this Order, shall be the sole responsibility of Respondent and not the Boards.

15. In the event Respondent relocates at any time prior to completing the terms of this Order, she shall notify the Boards of the change of address within 30 days of the effective date of such change.

16. Respondent is fully aware of and understands the right to receive a formal notice of hearing and charges and to have a formal disciplinary hearing, pursuant to § 12-43-224, C.R.S., and hereby waives those rights. Further, Respondent acknowledges that this waiver constitutes a waiver of all rights to appeal in this matter.

17. This Order is entered into by Respondent voluntarily and without coercion, after an opportunity to consult with counsel and with full understanding of the legal consequences of this Order and the right to a formal hearing on all matters herein.

18. This Order shall constitute a Board Order for purposes of § 12-43-222, C.R.S., and shall have the same force and effect as an order entered after a formal hearing pursuant to § 12-43-224, C.R.S.

19. Respondent acknowledges and agrees that any violation of this Order shall constitute a violation of a lawful Board Order and be grounds for further proceedings pursuant to the MHPA and, if proven, may constitute a basis for further disciplinary action. The pendency of any disciplinary action shall not affect the obligation of Respondent to comply with the terms of this Order, and this Order shall remain operative and in full force and effect.

20. Respondent shall obey all municipal, state, and federal laws while this Order is in effect.

21. This Order shall become an order of the Boards when it is accepted and signed by the Program Director or authorized Board representative.

22. This Order constitutes the entire agreement between Respondent and the Boards. There are no other promises expressed or implied. In the event that any provision of this Order is deemed unenforceable by a court of competent jurisdiction, such provision shall be severed, and the remainder of this Order shall be given full force and effect.

23. This Order shall become effective upon (a) mailing by first-class mail to Respondent at Respondent's address of record with the Boards, or (b) service by electronic means on Respondent at Respondent's electronic address of record with the Boards. Respondent hereby consents to service by electronic means if Respondent has an electronic address on file with the Boards.

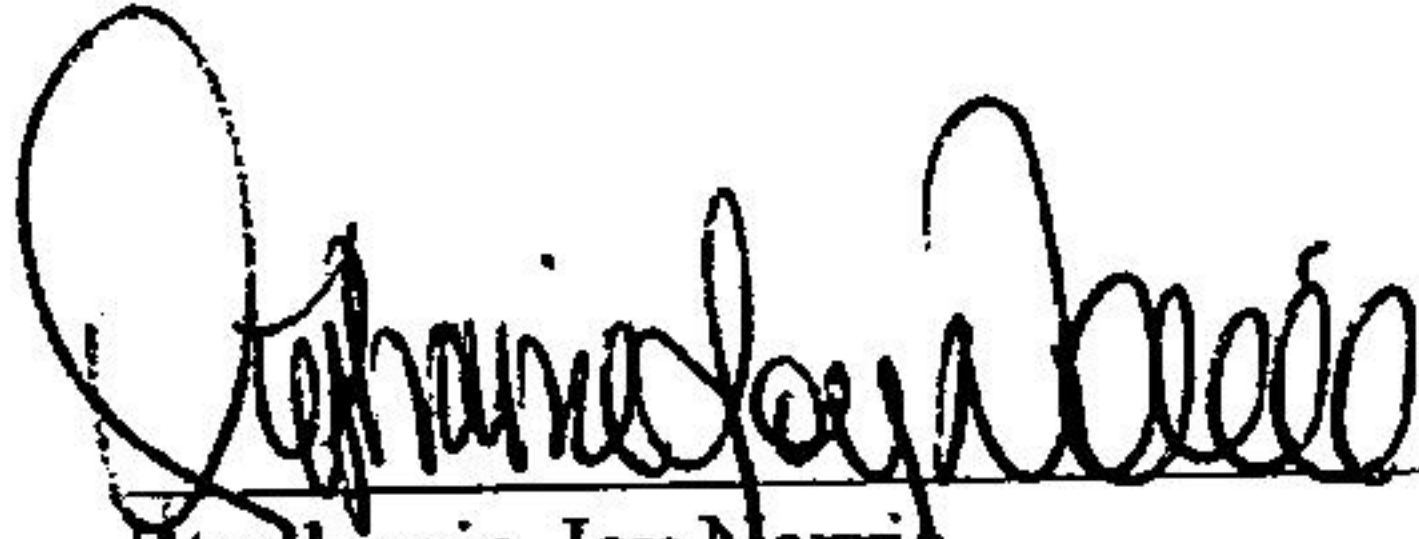
24. This Order shall be admissible as evidence at any hearing held before the Boards.

25. This Order shall be a public record in the custody of the Boards.

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AGREED TO AND ACCEPTED BY:

RESPONDENT



Stephanie Joy Norris
License Nos. LAC 822 and LPC 13426

AGREED TO AND ORDERED BY:

**STATE BOARD OF ADDICTION
COUNSELOR EXAMINERS AND
STATE BOARD OF LICENSED
PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR
EXAMINERS**



Ariana Busby
Program Director

Effective this Date:

10/3/2019